

HARDWARE

Radar



More Info on

the hardware products tested.
Check out

Mindware

A photo-quality inkjet printer, two handheld devices, the Dreamcast gaming console, an Internet TV and other products tested

Just another CD drive

The drive logged average results in the SiSoft Sandra test. However, the drive's speed while ripping tracks from an audio CD to wave format was quite good. Strangely enough, the drive showed higher performance when DMA was disabled. This is bad because when you enable DMA, performance should increase, which is not the case here.

Acer 56x CD-ROM Drive



SPECIFICATIONS:

56x read speed
Benchmarks:
Overall score in SiSoft Sandra: 1750
Sequential read speed of 2470 KBps
Random read speed of 676 KBps
Score of 1000 in CD Winmark
7 seconds to rip a 20.79 MB audio track to MP3, 15 seconds to rip the middle track of 42.24 MB and 19 seconds to rip the last track of 53.07 MB

verdict

B +

Acer 56x CD-ROM Drive

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Fast ripping time
+ Economical
- No software, no manuals
Price: Rs 2,100
Contact: Acer Communication
Phone: 022-5705730 **Fax:** 022-5705235
E-mail: joe@acercm.com.in
Web site: www.acercm.co.in

A powerhouse

Exceptionally light but still very rugged, this handheld is a design marvel when it comes to saving space and integrating components intelligently. There is a small button at the top left side of the handheld that allows you to take one-click voice notes and attach them to related text—a feature no Palm OS based handheld offers.

Compaq iPaq H3630



SPECIFICATIONS:

32 MB RAM, 16 MB of ROM, a 206 MHz Intel Strong ARM 32-bit processor, a 320x240 pixels wide TFT LCD screen, a built-in lithium ion rechargeable battery
Bundled software: Comes pre-installed with Pocket Word, Pocket Excel, Microsoft Reader for e-books, Microsoft Money and Microsoft's Windows Media Player for Pocket PC
Features: Plays Windows media files and has a 2.26x3.02 inch colour reflective TFT screen

verdict

A -

Compaq iPaq H3630

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Very feature-packed, colour display, powerful processor, multimedia-capable
- Excessively priced
Price: Rs 43,875
Contact: Radz Intellisync
Phone: 022-3678293 **Fax:** 022-3678193
E-mail: radz101@hotmail.com
Web site: www.radzinfo.com

Photo quality

A photo-quality inkjet printer aimed at the power user. The printer is very quiet, has above-average speed and a very impressive set of bundled software. The printer driver software is very simple to configure. The printer is also able to handle different media types including envelopes, transparencies and banners. The build quality was, however, average.

HP DeskJet 930C



SPECIFICATIONS:

Features: Accompanied by 17 CDs of BPP 250,000 Graphics and Delta Foto Suite. Allows printing on different paper sizes ranging from envelopes to banners
Benchmarks:
1 minute 38 seconds to print 5 pages of plain text in grayscale mode and 1 minute 37 seconds to print in normal colour mode
8 minutes 32 seconds to print 5 pages of high quality image in grayscale and 8 minutes 32 seconds to print in colour mode

verdict

A -

HP DeskJet 930C

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Very impressive photo printing
+ Silent
- Rather flimsy top cover
Price: Rs 9,999
Contact: Hewlett-Packard
Phone: 080-5216120 **Fax:** 080-5216121
E-mail: princy_bhatnagar@hp.com
Website: www.hpindia.com